

Unless we have a strong local electronics market or think of the export potential, semiconductor manufacturing, particularly at the high end, would not be viable."

UID project to have fingerprints and iris scans

The cabinet committee on India's unique identification (UID) project has decided to use all ten fingerprints, an iris scan and a photograph of the person for unique identification of individuals, giving its in-principle clearance to guidelines for setting up the UID database.

In a billion-plus population, a mix of biometric and photographic record is considered necessary to ensure fidelity of information collected in the project. With UID intended to help identify beneficiaries of welfare schemes, children aged between five and 15 years will be included in view of the ambitious right to education.

Philips eyes 39 per cent share of audio market

Philips expects to more than double its market share in the Indian audio market over the next two-three years. The company is planning to launch an online forum and software, Philips Songbird, to help it compete against the iPod. It is also in talks with Indian partners like raaga.com to customise content for India.

Philips claims Songbird will be a crucial part of its strategy to attain leadership in the Indian MP3 player market where it is currently at the second slot after Apple. Industry estimates suggest that the MP3 player market is worth Rs 3.8 billion, with Apple enjoying some 30-35 per cent share followed by Philips with 15 per cent share.

Sony bullish on Blu-ray products

Sony in India plans big for the Blu-ray market with the introduction of Blu-ray audio-visual products at a starting price of Rs 9990 and doubling of the number of Blu-ray movie titles to 500.

Blu-ray enabled products will be available in a wide range including Blu-ray disk players, home theatre systems, PlayStation3 and VAIO, which will provide High Definition picture and audio quality as well as Internet connectivity to consumers.

Blu-ray market is expected to grow



Sony BDP-S350 Blu-ray player

up to 500,000 units by FY2012. Looking at a ten-fold growth in volume, Sony plans to capture 60 per cent market share and increase the number of outlets to 4000 by FY2012.

Videocon d2h expands pan-India

Videocon d2h, the direct-to-home (D2H) service provider arm of Videocon Group, has announced its pan-India presence. It was first launched in the Punjab market, followed by a phase-wise launch across various regions and most recently in Kerala.

Videocon d2h offers a range of satellite products, including satellite LCDs, satellite TVs, satellite DVD players as well as satellite set-top boxes.

Samsung targets 30 per cent market share in laser printers

Samsung Electronics has launched eight new models in laser printer, multifunction printer and network printer categories, including the world's smallest laser printer ML1666. The company is targeting a 30 per cent market share and a 58 per cent jump in volumes this year based on its considerably enhanced product offering, strengthened distribution channel and a sharper focus on B2B business.

Announcing the launch of new laser printers, Ranjit Yadav, director, mobile & IT, Samsung Electronics, said, "Printers, LCD monitors and note PCs are the growth drivers for our IT business this year. Within the printing space, our enhanced lineup across

both the entry-level as well as the mid-/high-end, coupled with our enhanced distribution this year, especially at Tier 2 and Tier 3 channel levels, should see us emerge as a strong No. 2 player in the market."

With a sharpened focus on the B2B business, the company is expecting

laser printers to contribute 30 per cent to its printer volumes this year.

Philips sets up innovation campus for healthcare

Philips Innovation Campus (PIC) in Bengaluru has outlined its plan of activity for the coming year. Its key area of activity would be developing cutting-edge technologies for the healthcare sector, but now with an increased focus on India. The announcement was made by Dr Wido Menhardt, who has taken over as chief executive officer of Philips Innovation Campus. PIC contributes to the robust portfolio of Philips medical systems.

Dr Menhardt also announced commencement of the development activity for Philips lighting. Keeping in mind both the consumers' requirements and environmental concerns, Philips will develop a range of innovative digital lighting solutions for global markets.

BPL Techno Vision upbeat on LED products

British Physical Laboratories (BPL) India, which was established in the year 1963 as a single product company manufacturing high-precision hermetically sealed panel meters for defence applications, had ruled the consumer market with its brand of colour televisions in collaboration with Sanyo.

Today, the company has been revived and is planning to regain its lost glory in the consumer electronics market with its solar rechargeable LED-